Census and Urbanisation Topic 7 — World Population and Demographic Miscellaneous

Current Affairs

Year	Fact	Why it matters
Rolling	Refresh edition-bound figures from latest Census / Survey / State CA desks.	Do not invent interim totals.

UP district extremes also → UP Special Topic 6. This chapter owns the national Census / demography desk.

Teaching cards

2.1 Continental and Regional Distribution of Global Population

A. Continental Population Shares (2024)

- **Asia**: Contains approximately **60% of the world's population (~4.8 Billion)**. Home to the two population giants: India and China. High density in South Asia, East Asia, and Southeast Asia.
- **Africa**: Accounts for approximately **18% of the world's population (~1.5 Billion)**. Fastest growing continent globally (TFR ~4.2). Projected to account for more than half of global population growth between now and 2050.
- **Europe**: Accounts for approximately **9.5% of the world's population (~745 Million)**. Experiencing negative natural growth, sub-replacement fertility, and acute population aging.
- **North America**: Accounts for approximately **7.5% (~600 Million including Central America/Caribbean; Northern America alone is ~380 Million)**.
- **South America**: Accounts for approximately **5.5% (~440 Million)**.
- **Oceania**: Accounts for approximately **0.5% (~45 Million)**.



B. Global Density Extremes

- **Highest Density Territories / Micro-States**: 1. **Monaco**: **~26,000 persons / km²** (World's most densely populated sovereign state). 2. **Singapore**: **~8,300 persons / km²**. 3. **Bahrain**: ~1,850 persons / km². 4. **Maldives**: ~1,750 persons / km². 5. **Bangladesh**: **~1,160 persons / km²** (*Most densely populated large country with population > 10 ext{ Million}*).

- **Lowest Density Sovereign Countries**: 1. **Greenland (Autonomous Denmark)**: **0.03 persons / km²** (Lowest overall territory). 2. **Mongolia**: **~2.1 persons / km²** (World's least densely populated sovereign nation). 3. **Namibia**: ~3.1 persons / km². 4. **Australia**: **~3.3 persons / km²**. 5. **Canada**: **~4.0 persons / km²**. 6. **Iceland**: ~3.7 persons / km².

2.2 Flagship Demographic Institutions & Publications

1. **United Nations Population Division (UN DESA)**: - Publishes the biennial flagship report **World Population Prospects (WPP)**, the official global benchmark for demographic estimates, life tables, and population projections.
2. **United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA)**: - Established in **1969** (originally UN Fund for Population Activities), headquartered in **New York**. - Publishes the annual **State of World Population (SWOP)** report.
3. **International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS)**: - Established in **1956** in **Mumbai**, India, as an autonomous regional centre for training and research in population studies. - Designated as the nodal agency by MoHFW for conducting all rounds of the **National Family Health Survey (NFHS)** and the Longitudinal Ageing Study in India (LASI).

Bilingual Terminology -- World Population and Demographic Miscellaneous

English Term	Hindi Term	Key Anchor
World Population Day	विश्व जनसंख्या दिवस	11 July (since 1989; UNFPA initiative)
UNFPA	संयुक्त राष्ट्र जनसंख्या कोष	United Nations Population Fund; HQ: New York
World Population Report	विश्व जनसंख्या रिपोर्ट	Published annually by UNFPA
World Bank Development Report	विश्व बैंक विकास रिपोर्ट	Annual; covers development themes including demographics
Human Development Index (HDI)	मानव विकास सूचकांक	UNDP; GNI/capita + Life expectancy + Education
Gender Development Index (GDI)	लिंग विकास सूचकांक	HDI disaggregated by gender
Gender Inequality Index (GII)	लिंग असमानता सूचकांक	UNDP; reproductive health + empowerment + labour
Population Clock	जनसंख्या घड़ी	Real-time world population counter (UN/US Census Bureau)
Demographic Bonus	जनांकिकीय बोनस	Synonym for Demographic Dividend
Ageing Population	वृद्ध होती जनसंख्या	Rising proportion of elderly (65+) in total population
Greying of Population	जनसंख्या का बुजुर्ग होना	Increasing median age due to declining fertility and mortality

English Term	Hindi Term	Key Anchor
Zero Population Growth	शून्य जनसंख्या वृद्धि	Birth rate equals death rate; TFR at exact replacement level
Negative Population Growth	ऋणात्मक जनसंख्या वृद्धि	Deaths exceed births; population declines
World's Most Populous Country	विश्व का सर्वाधिक जनसंख्या वाला देश	India (~April 2023 surpassed China)

Extended Theory -- World Population Dynamics

```
WORLD POPULATION MILESTONES
---------------------------

1804 ——— World population reached 1 Billion
1927 ——— 2 Billion (123 years later)
1960 ——— 3 Billion (33 years later)
1974 ——— 4 Billion (14 years later)
1987 ——— 5 Billion (13 years later) -- "Day of 5 Billion" = 11 July
1999 ——— 6 Billion (12 years later) -- "Day of 6 Billion" = 12 October
2011 ——— 7 Billion (12 years later) -- "Day of 7 Billion" = 31 October
2022 ——— 8 Billion (November 2022)
~2037 —— 9 Billion (projected)

IMPORTANT: World Population Day = 11 July (since 1989)
Origin: 11 July 1987 = Day of 5 Billion people
```

Top 10 Most Populous Countries (2023 Estimates)

Rank	Country	Population (approx.)
1	**India**	~1.43 Billion
2	**China**	~1.41 Billion
3	USA	~340 Million
4	Indonesia	~278 Million
5	Pakistan	~240 Million
6	Brazil	~216 Million
7	Nigeria	~220 Million
8	Bangladesh	~170 Million
9	Russia	~145 Million
10	Ethiopia	~125 Million

Key International Organisations in Demography

Organisation	Full Form	Key Demographic Function
UNFPA	United Nations Population Fund	Annual World Population Report; family planning support
UN DESA	UN Department of Economic and Social Affairs	World Population Prospects (biennial)
WHO	World Health Organization	Global health statistics, mortality data
World Bank	International Bank for Reconstruction & Development	World Development Indicators; WDR
ILO	International Labour Organization	Labour force statistics, employment data
UNDP	UN Development Programme	HDI, GII, GDI rankings

India in World Demographic Context

Parameter	India's Position	Key Note
Population	**1st** (surpassed China ~April 2023)	UN World Population Prospects 2022
Area	7th largest country by area	2.4% of world's land area
Population Density	Among highest globally	382/km2 vs world avg ~60/km2
TFR	Below replacement level (~2.0)	First time in India's history
Working-age population	Largest in world	Demographic dividend advantage

One-Liner Revision -- World Population Misc

#	Fast Fact
1	World Population Day = **11 July** (since 1989)
2	Origin: 11 July 1987 = world hit **5 billion**
3	World population milestone dates: 1B(1804), 2B(1927), 5B(1987), 7B(2011), 8B(2022)
4	World population 2022 = **8 billion** (15 Nov 2022)
5	India surpassed China = **April 2023**
6	India population (~2023) = **~1.43 Billion**
7	China population (~2023) = **~1.41 Billion**
8	2nd most populous country = **China**
9	3rd most populous country = **USA (~340 million)**

#	Fast Fact
10	HDI published by **UNDP** (Human Development Report)
11	GII = Gender Inequality Index (UNDP)
12	GDI = Gender Development Index (UNDP)
13	World Population Report published by **UNFPA**
14	World Development Indicators published by **World Bank**
15	World Population Prospects = **UN DESA** (biennial)
16	Most densely populated country = **Bangladesh** (~1,100+/km2)
17	Least densely populated country = **Mongolia** (~2/km2)
18	Fastest growing continent = **Africa**
19	Ageing / Greying population problem = **Japan, Europe**
20	China's One-Child Policy (1980-2015) -- replaced by Three-Child Policy (2021)